Smart Museum Guide

Colombo National Museum · Mobile Visitor Guide · Project Plan

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What I am building

A free mobile app for museum visitors, working on both Android phones and iPhones.

A visitor opens the app and chooses English, Sinhala or Tamil. They walk to an exhibit and scan the QR code sticker beside it. The app then shows something about that object and plays a spoken explanation in their language.

I also build a simple website for museum staff. Staff log in, add a new object, upload its files, and print its QR code. The app picks up the new object straight away. **No developer is needed to add objects later.**

What the visitor sees

Different objects suit different treatments, so the app offers three.

Experience	What happens	Suits
Video	A short film plays on the phone, with narration	Paintings, textiles, flat objects
3D model	The visitor points the phone at the floor and a full-size copy of the object appears. They can walk around it and see every side	Statues and sculptures
Text on the object	The visitor points the phone at the real exhibit. The meaning of the writing appears on top of it	Stone inscriptions

Every experience includes spoken narration in all three languages.

The four weeks

Week	What I build	What you can see at the end of it
One	The app foundation and languages	Open the app and switch between all three languages
Two	QR scanning, object pages, video	Scan a code and watch a video with narration
Three	The 3D experience	Point at the floor and see an object appear
Four	The staff website and handover	Your own staff add a new object without me

Week one — The app takes shape

I build the frame of the app: the opening screen, the language choice and the main menu. I set up the system that will hold all the object information.

On the very first day I test the 3D technology on real phones. I do this before anything else so that there are no surprises later in the project.

At the end of this week: you can install the app on a phone, open it, and switch between English, Sinhala and Tamil.

Week two — Scanning works

I build the QR scanner and connect it to the object information, so that scanning a code brings up the right exhibit. I build the object page showing the picture, title, period and description. I then build the video experience with spoken narration.

At the end of this week: you can scan a QR code beside an exhibit, see its details on screen, and watch a video with narration in your chosen language.

> **I would like to show you this in person.** It is the first time the whole idea works from end to end, and the best moment for you to tell me if anything should change.

Week three — The 3D experience

I build the experience where a full-size copy of an object appears in the room. The visitor walks around it, looks at the back, and hears the explanation while they do.

I also handle older phones. The app checks each visitor's phone automatically. Phones that cannot show an object in the room instead show it on the screen, turned with a finger.

At the end of this week: you can scan a QR code, point the phone at the floor, and see the object appear with narration playing.

> **Nobody sees an error message.** A visitor with an older phone still gets the object, the pictures, the text and the narration — just on the screen rather than in the room.

Week four — You take control of the content

I build the staff website: logging in, adding and editing objects, uploading files, and printing QR codes. I load your real objects into the system, test the app across different phones, and fix whatever I find.

I then hand everything over and train your staff to use it.

At the end of this week: a member of your staff can add a brand new object, print its QR code, stick it beside the exhibit, and it works in the app immediately — without contacting me.